

Libby loves science, especially chemistry. Her chemistry teacher, Mr. Darwin, once said, “It’s okay to make mistakes because they can lead to new findings. And making mistakes is more fun than cleaning up.”

One day, Mr. Darwin said, “We will run the science station at our school’s Autumn Festival. The station with the most visitors wins an ice-cream party.” He chose Libby, Rosa, and Finn to help with the station. The girls were excited. They picked three favourite experiments for the festival-making big bubbles (泡泡), mixing soft slime (史莱姆), and launching a rocket. “I can’t wait!” said Libby.

The festival day finally came. All the stations were busy except the science station, so the girls decided to try something interesting. They made big bubbles first. People started to come over. Then, Rosa used salty water to make very soft slime. “Now for the rocket! If we use more baking soda (小苏打), the rocket might go higher,” said Libby.

Unluckily, when Libby added the baking soda, an accident happened – water got on the kids. Everyone got wet and ran away. In the end, they had no visitors.

The girls didn’t win. Libby felt sad. But Mr. Darwin told them, “You three did a great job!” “But we didn’t win,” mumbled (嘟囔) Libby. “That DOESN’T mean we can’t be proud of how hard you tried. We can have our OWN ice-cream party!” “We’ll get ice and milk!” cheered the girls.

“Yum. This is delicious,” said Finn after tasting their homemade ice-cream. “It’s okay to make mistakes,” said Rosa. “And it’s so much more fun than cleaning up!” smiled Libby.

1. What is Libby’s favourite subject?

- A. Maths. B. English. C. Chemistry. D. Geography.

2. Which experiments did the girls choose to do at the science station?

- A. Making big bubbles, mixing soft slime, and launching a rocket.
B. Making big bubbles, mixing hard slime, and launching a rocket.
C. Making small bubbles, mixing soft slime, and launching a paper plane.
D. Making small bubbles, mixing hard slime, and launching a paper plane.

3. How did Libby feel when they lost?

- A. Excited. B. Angry. C. Proud. D. Unhappy.

4. What kind of person is Mr. Darwin?

- A. Boring. B. Helpful. C. Energetic. D. Careful.

5. What is the most important lesson to learn from this story?

- A. Working together is the key to success.
B. Don’t do experiments without a teacher’s help.
C. Remember to clean up after doing an experiment.
D. Making mistakes gives us new ideas and helps us grow.

How fit are your teeth? Are you lazy about brushing them? Never fear: An inventor is on the case. An electric toothbrush senses how long and how well you brush, and it lets you track your performance on your phone.

The Kolibree toothbrush was exhibited at the International Consumer Electronics Show in Las Vegas this week. It senses how it is moved and can send the information to an Android phone or iPhone via a Bluetooth wireless connection. The toothbrush will be able to teach you to brush right (Don't forget the insides of the teeth!) and make sure you're brushing long enough. "It's kind of like having a dentist actually watch your brushing on a day-to-day basis," says Thomas Serval, the French inventor.

The toothbrush will also be able to talk to other programs on your phone, so developers could, for example, create a game controlled by your toothbrush. You could score points for beating monsters among your teeth. "We try to make it smart but also fun," Serval says.

Serval says he was inspired by his experience as a father. He would come home from work and ask his kids if they had brushed their teeth. They said "yes", but Serval would find their toothbrush heads dry. He decided he needed a brush that really told him how well his children brushed.

The company says the Kolibree will go on sale this summer, from \$99 to \$199, depending on features. The U. S. is the first target market.

Serval says that one day, it'll be possible to replace (更换) the brush on the handle with a brushing unit that also has a camera. The camera can even examine holes in your teeth while you brush.

1. Which statement about the Kolibree toothbrush is TRUE?

- A. It can send information to your phone.
- B. It can clean teeth all by itself.
- C. It looks like a dentist.
- D. It can talk with us.

2. Why did Serval decide to invent the toothbrush?

- A. Because he could score points in games while brushing teeth.
- B. Because he wanted to make sure his children could brush teeth well.
- C. Because he wanted to replace the brush on the handle with a new one.
- D. Because he wanted to invent an electric toothbrush for the market.

3. What can we know from the passage?

- A. Only parents care about children's teeth health.
- B. The Kolibree toothbrush has a fixed price.
- C. The toothbrush with a camera is already on the market.
- D. The inventor is confident about the future of his product.

4. What is the main idea of the passage?

- A. Children do not brush teeth right.
- B. A new toothbrush is able to control games.
- C. People are paying more and more attention to teeth health.
- D. Serval's invention will be able to check the user's teeth.



Think of a world full of pops and laughter! That is the fun of bubble wrap (气泡包装), one of the best inventions ever. But did you know that it wasn't made for popping in the beginning? This brings us to its funny story! Let's learn more about it!

In 1957, two engineers tried to invent a new kind of wallpaper. They put two shower curtains together with air bubbles between them. The result? A bumpy (不平整的), bubbly mess! Instead of cool wallpaper, they made something much more exciting.

However, bubble wrap didn't work as wallpaper at first. In fact, it wasn't used for anything because it wasn't flat! But when people saw it protected fragile things well, they sold it as packing material. Soon, people used bubble wrap to protect glass and electronics during shipping.

But it wasn't popular until people fell in love with its fun "pop". They started popping it for enjoyment, making it a playful activity. Many say popping bubble wrap helps them relax by popping their worries away!

People use bubble wrap for packing, making art projects, and as a fun toy. Some companies make bubble wrap so that you can pop it again and again, so the fun keeps going!

The next time you open a package and hear the fun pops, think about bubble wrap's journey—from a failed wallpaper idea to a perfect stress—relieving toy. This change shows that sometimes good inventions come from happy accidents and a bit of imagination!

1. Why did the two engineers invent bubble wrap in the first place?

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|---|
| A. To create a new art project. | B. To make a stress-relieving toy. |
| C. To invent a new kind of wallpaper. | D. To protect fragile things during shipping. |

2. What does the underlined word "fragile" in paragraph 3 mean?

- | | | | |
|---------------|----------|--------------|---------------|
| A. Expensive. | B. Tiny. | C. Artistic. | D. Breakable. |
|---------------|----------|--------------|---------------|

3. Why do people like popping bubble wrap?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A. Because it looks beautiful. | B. Because it protects fragile things. |
| C. Because it helps make art projects. | D. Because it makes them feel less stressed. |

4. According to the writer, what makes this invention successful?

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| A. Fun and excitement. | B. Careful planning and design. |
| C. Lucky accidents and imagination. | D. Smart people and their hard work. |

5. What is the best title for the passage?

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| A. Two Smart Engineers | B. The Best Invention |
| C. The Perfect Stress-relieving Toy | D. The Fun Journey of Bubble Wrap |

Imagine that the battery on your mobile phone has run out. You can't make any calls for help and no one can contact you. You are all alone, and well, not quite. Just reach into your pocket and take out a piece of sugar. Put it into the battery, wait a minute and you are back on the phone.

Thanks to a couple of American scientists, this situation (情况) could become real. Swadesh Chaudhuri and Derek Lovely have invented the "bacteria (细菌) battery". This kind of battery gets its power from bacteria that eat sugar and turn it into electricity.

"This is a special organism (有机体)," Lovely said. "You can get enough electricity to power a cell phone battery for about four days from a spoonful (一勺) of sugar."

In the past, bacteria batteries have been expensive and not long-lasting. But this battery uses a more efficient (有效率的) bacterium that can turn 80 percent of sugar into electrical energy. This is 30 percent more than similar batteries can manage.

The bacteria battery could become as small as a household battery. It is also cheap and stable (稳定的), because sugar can be taken from waste and crops.

But the sugar-to-electricity process (过程) is not satisfactory as it could take weeks for the bacteria to change a cup of sugar into electricity. And it produces "greenhouse" gases which pollute the environment.

The scientists understand there is a lot more work to be done. "It is still young," said Lovely.

"Where we are now is where solar power was 20 or 30 years ago."

He also believes the battery will be used in scientific equipment at the bottom of the ocean. Ocher's ideas include using sugar in the blood to run medical devices in the human body and taking sugar from animal waste to provide energy to power homes in the countryside.

1. What's the passage mainly about?

- A. An effective way to repair the mobile phone. B. A scientific invention of a new type of battery.
C. A clean energy to reduce the carbon dioxide. D. A new kind of mobile phone and its future.

2. Which of the following is NOT the advantage (优点) of the newly-developed battery?

- A. Convenient. B. Stable. C. Inexpensive. D. Quick.

3. Which of the following are the scientists working on to improve the new battery?

- A. Increase the bacteria. B. Solve the pollution problem.
C. Bring down the price. D. Change the size of the battery.

4. What does the underlined sentence actually mean?

- A. The bacteria battery shares some similarities with solar energy.
B. Scientists will continue their work until they find solar power.
C. There is still much room for the improvement of the bacteria battery.
D. The bacteria battery will be as popular as solar power in twenty or thirty years.

5. According to the last paragraph, who will find the bacteria battery less useful?

- A. Divers. B. Farmers. C. Doctors. D. Cooks.

Scientists say they have had a “conversation” with a humpback whale (座头鲸). The scientists are from the University of California, the Alaska Whale Foundation and the SETI Institute (Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence Institute 搜寻地球外文明研究所). They teamed up and spoke to a humpback whale named Twain. They spoke to her in “humpback language” for 20 minutes. Their conversation took place after the scientists sent a “contact call” into the ocean off the coast of Alaska. Twain heard the call and responded (回应). She swam to the research boat, circled it and chatted. The SETI Institute said it was the first ever communication between humans and a humpback whale.

The scientists said their conversation with Twain was not a deep one. Professor Brenda Mc Cowan said it was more like a series of greetings. Whales use contact calls to let other whales know where they are. The scientists made the same call 36 times over a 20-minute period. Each time, Twain responded by calling back. She even matched the intervals (间隔) between each call that the researchers made, which greatly surprised the scientists.

Professor Brenda Mc Cowan told the Business Insider website that this research could make it easier to talk to aliens (外星人). She said, “There are many kinds of intelligent beings on this planet. By studying them, we can better understand what aliens might be like.” Based on this research, scientists may identify calls from space and make first contact with aliens in the future.

1. Where did the “conversation” take place?

- A. In the SETI Institute
- B. In the Alaska Whale Foundation.
- C. In the ocean off the coast of Alaska.
- D. In the University of California.

2. Which of the following is TRUE about Twain?

- A. Twain was in poor condition.
- B. Twain jumped out of the water 36 times.
- C. Twain responded to the scientist’s call 20 times.
- D. Twain was so smart that the scientists all felt surprised.

3. What can we learn from the last paragraph?

- A. Scientists have received calls from space.
- B. There are few intelligent beings on Earth.
- C. This research may help humans contact aliens.
- D. People can talk with other animals in the future.

4. Which question is answered in this passage?

- A. Why do the scientists want to search for aliens?
- B. How many scientists took part in the research?
- C. What will people do to protect humpback whales?
- D. How did the scientists have a “conversation” with Twain?

5. Where is the passage possibly from?

- A. A travel guide.
- B. A health report.
- C. A storybook.
- D. A science magazine.



A 58-year-old grape farmer Tang Jianqin uses family skills and modern technologies to get lots of sales (买卖) since the beginning of June, and he received many online orders in October.

“I introduce (引进) at least one new kind of grapes every year to keep up with the market,” says Tang. Earlier this year, Tang introduced a new grape kind without seeds and much bigger than the ordinary grapes. It is better that the new grape kind has a brighter color and a sweeter taste. In late August, this amazing grape won the gold prize at a competition.

Tang thanks his success to today’s technologies. “WeChat groups have connected farmers and agricultural (农业) experts (专家). One can share problems and find solutions immediately.” He learns online that the control of production helps his new grape kind grow better.

For years, experts have given farmers advice online. They have also made training (培训) videos for farmers so that the farmers can watch them for many times. Tang is now good at using the Internet to run his business. Every day, he checks online orders through the local online platform.

Tang’s new grapes are now sold at 60 yuan (\$8.7) a kilogram. With the online guidance from the experts and the help from the government, he has built an agricultural center, along with a supermarket and a farming school. In the near future, the farmer hopes to keep developing his business online. “I also want to hire young people to keep up with the times,” he adds.

1. When did the farmer get online orders?

- A. In June. B. In August. C. In October. D. In November.

2. Why did the farmer introduce a new grape kind every year?

- A. To eat bigger grapes without seeds. B. To keep up with the market.
C. To show people that he is right. D. To change the fruit market.

3. What helps Tang’s new grape kind grow better?

- A. More seeds and bigger grapes. B. The control of production.
C. The gold prize in late August. D. Today’s new technologies.

4. Which are the advantages of the Internet for farmers according to Paragraph 3 and 4?

- ①Sharing problems and finding solutions ②Getting online advice from experts
③Watching training videos from the experts ④Checking orders through the international platform
A. ①②③ B. ①②④ C. ①③④ D. ②③④

5. What is the main idea of the passage?

- A. Experts learn a lot from the online training B. Family skills make the grapes grow better
C. More young people are joining in farming D. Modern technologies help farmers’ business

A new and exciting way of doing weather forecasts is here! China's television station now uses high-tech simulations (虚拟) to create realistic scenes in the studio. In a recent video about Super Typhoon Yagi, people watched as strong winds blew the weather reporter's umbrella away and a "tree" was uprooted. This new way of forecasting weather helps people understand how serious storms can be.

China Media Group Mobile made this video to warn people about the dangers of Super Typhoon Yagi and to tell them how to stay safe. But people were surprised by how real the video looked.

The weather reporter started by talking about the weather. Then, she moved to a street with heavy winds and rain, created by extended (拓展) reality (XR) technology. XR is a group of technologies that includes augmented (增强) reality (AR), virtual (虚拟) reality (VR), and mixed reality (MR).

The video showed different things that could happen during a typhoon, like trees falling and umbrellas blown away. It made people feel like they were really there, experiencing the typhoon.

With XR technology, the scenes looked real and helped people learn about the dangers of extreme (极端的) weather. Many people who watched the video said they loved the new way of doing weather forecasts because it helped them understand better.

Super Typhoon Yagi was the strongest autumn typhoon to hit the Chinese mainland since 1949. It caused a lot of damage and problems for people. The new way of doing weather forecasts helps people see how serious extreme weather can be.

1. What happened to the weather reporter's umbrella in the weather forecast video?

- | | |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------|
| A. It turned inside out. | B. It broke in the wind. |
| C. It flew out of her hand. | D. It didn't open. |

2. What new technology is being used for weather forecasts in China?

- | | |
|-------------------------|----------------------------|
| A. Virtual Reality (VR) | B. Augmented Reality (AR). |
| C. Mixed Reality (MR). | D. Extended Reality (XR). |

3. What does the underlined word "they" in Paragraph 4 mean?

- | | |
|-----------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| A. The weather reporters. | B. The people who watched the video. |
| C. The people in the video. | D. The China Media Group Mobile. |

4. What was the purpose of the Super Typhoon Yagi weather forecast video?

- A. To warn people about the dangers of the typhoon.
- B. To show off the power of XR technology.
- C. To make people happy with new technology.
- D. To show us the strongest autumn typhoon.

5. What's the best title for the text?

- | | |
|--|---|
| A. The development of XR technology | B. The new way of doing weather forecasts |
| C. The ability of the weather reporter | D. The dangers of Super Typhoon Yagi |



Jokes made by AI lack (缺乏) creative thinking. It seems you can ask artificial intelligence (AI) programs anything, and they'll give you an answer. So, can they tell jokes?

This question was raised by a UK comedian (喜剧演员) Karen Hobbs in one of her shows in June. Instead of the usual jokes she created, Hobbs told jokes written by ChatGPT.

When Hobbs asked ChatGPT for a joke, it gave one about a man joking about getting bored with his shopping-obsessed (痴迷于购物的) girlfriend. Even when she asked to tell it from a woman's perspective (视角), it was still a shopping-obsessed girlfriend but told in the first person.

It's no surprise that many jokes by AI come from a man's perspective, as men are much more common in comedy. The BBC said that AI storytelling can only create stories based on what is already there.

A good joke in real life can always change based on the audience's reaction (反应). This is a skill that often leads comedians to improvise (即兴创作). That's something that AI can't do for now. For example, in improvise (即兴创作), comedians don't make preparations. They depend only on their natural reaction to the audience.

However, that could change. Research is being done to give AI a greater understanding of the world around it, which makes the future of AI jokes still uncertain.

1. What did Karen Hobbs do in one of her shows in June?

- A. She told jokes written by herself. B. She performed a magic trick.
C. She sang a song. D. She told jokes written by ChatGPT.

2. Who is more common in comedy according to the passage?

- A. Women B. Men. C. Children. D. Elderly people.

3. What did the BBC say about AI storytelling?

- A. AI can create completely new stories.
B. AI can only create stories based on existing (现存的) ones.
C. AI storytelling is not popular.
D. AI can improvise stories like humans.

4. What do comedians depend on in improvise?

- A. Their prepared scripts (手稿). B. The audience's suggestions.
C. Their natural reaction to the audience. D. Their previous performances.

5. What can be inferred (推断) from the last sentence of the passage?

- A. AI jokes will never be funny.
B. The future of AI jokes is for sure.
C. AI might improve its ability to tell jokes in the future.
D. Research on AI has stopped.

Do you have a lucky number? What is it? Many people have a special number that they hope will bring them good luck.

In Chinese culture, some numbers are believed to be lucky or unlucky based on the Chinese word that the number sounds similar to.

For example, the word for the number 8 sounds similar to the word for “making a fortune (发财)”. So, people consider it a very lucky number. Some people will even spend a lot of money to have 8s in their phone number or on their vehicle license plate (车牌照) number. The opening ceremony of the Beijing Olympics began at 8:08 p.m. on Aug. 8, 2008.

The number 9 is also a lucky number because of its connection to the emperors of China. There were nine dragons on emperors’ robes (龙袍) and Chinese myth held that the dragon had nine children. The number 9 also stands for “long lasting”. That’s why a man always proposes (求婚) to a woman with 99 or 999 roses.

So, what’s an unlucky number in China? One example is 4. Many Chinese people see 4 as an unlucky number because it sounds similar to the character for “death”.

Because of this, many buildings skip (跳过) the fourth floor, and simply call it the fifth floor. In Hong Kong, some buildings even skip all floors numbered with 4, such as 4, 14, 24, 34 and all 40-49 floors. Some buildings also skip the 13th floor, as this is considered an unlucky number in some areas in Hong Kong. As a result, a building whose highest floor is 50 may have only 35 physical floors.

1. What makes Chinese people believe a number is lucky or unlucky?

- | | |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| A. The shape of the number. | B. The sound of the number. |
| C. The history of the number. | D. The spelling of the number. |

2. A building whose highest floor is 60 in Hong Kong might only have _____ physical floors if it skips all the unlucky numbers.

- | | | | |
|-------|-------|-------|-------|
| A. 35 | B. 60 | C. 45 | D. 44 |
|-------|-------|-------|-------|

3. According to the passage, the meaning of number 9 in Chinese culture is _____.

- | | | | |
|--------------|-------------|----------------|-----------|
| A. fortunate | B. ordinary | C. everlasting | D. simple |
|--------------|-------------|----------------|-----------|

4. What is the passage mainly about?

- A. Numbers and old stories in China.
B. Lucky and unlucky numbers in Chinese culture.
C. Ways to find your lucky and unlucky numbers.
D. Different meanings of numbers in different countries.

Each number is special and has its own beauty. They are basic elements (元素) of mathematics for counting, measuring, and solving equations (方程). Numbers hold a lot of fun facts and stories. Today, we invite you on a journey through some of them.

Zero

The ancient Babylonians (巴比伦人) invented zero, and it is the greatest number in the world. It was the age of Henry VI (亨利六世) when he became King of England (he was nine months old). Also when he became King of France (he was eleven months old). It's the total number of snakes in Ireland (because of the cooler and wetter environment).

Three

Three is a creepy number in some cultures. In Vietnam, it's bad luck to have three people in a photo as the one in the middle might die. It's the number of people who have been to the bottom of the ocean (the Mariana Trench). It's (on average) the number of days you can survive without water, the number of weeks you can survive without eating and the number of minutes you can survive without taking a breath.

Seven

Ah, Number Seven. It's seen as lucky or mystical (神秘的) in some cultures. It appears all the time. Seven days of the week. Seven ancient wonders. Seven Dwarves too. It's the estimated (估计) number of Northern white rhinos left in the world.

Ten

Human children need around 10 hours of sleep a night (you'd need two hours if you were a giraffe and twenty-two hours if you were a koala). 10 percent of the world is left-handed. The world's largest omelette (煎蛋) was 10 metres wide. 10 percent of people in the world live on islands.

1. What can people use numbers to do EXCEPT?

A. To count. B. To measure. C. To solve equations. D. To go traveling

2. How old was Henry VI when he became King of England?

A. One year old. B. Eleven months old. C. Nine months old. D. Six months old.

3. What can we know about Three and Seven?

A. Three is unlucky in some cultures. B. Seven is bad luck in Vietnam.
C. Seven sometimes appear in our lives. D. People can survive 3 weeks without water.

4. How much sleep does a child need every night?

A. 22 hours B. 10 hours C. 8 hours D. 2 hours

5. Where can we probably read this article?

A. In a health magazine B. In a sports newspaper C. In a Maths blog D. In a travel guide

The Mayan number system appeared in the fourth century, which was about 1,000 years earlier than the time when the European number system was created. It is different from the Arabic number system with a base 10. The Mayan system had a base 20. This system is believed to have been used because the Mayans lived in such a warm area and there was hardly a need to wear shoes. 20 was the total number of fingers and toes, so the system was workable. Therefore, there were two important numbers in this system. Besides 20, the other important number is 5, which had a connection with the number of fingers and toes on one hand or foot.

The Mayan system used two symbols (符号). A dot (·) was used to mean the units (one to four) and a dash (—) meant five. The Mayans were also the first to create symbols of nothing (or zero). The most common symbol was that of a shell () but there were several other symbols (e.g. a head). It is interesting to learn that with all of the great experts on Maths and scientists in ancient Greece and Rome, it was the Mayan Indians who came up with this symbol zero or nothing. The following picture is a form of different numbers and how they would have been written.

From further study, people found that the 360 day calendar (日历) also came from the Mayan. They  actually used base 18 when they made the calendar. Each month included 20 days with 18 months in a year. This left five days at the end of the year which was month in itself, full of danger and bad luck. In this way, the Mayans had invented the 365 day calendar.

1. What does the underlined “It” in paragraph 1 refer to?

- A. The European number system. B. The Mayan number system.
C. The Arabic number system. D. The Mayan symbol system.

2. Why could the Mayan system be used at that time?

- A. People lived in such a warm area that they didn't need to count numbers.
B. People believed that they hardly used their fingers or toes to count numbers.
C. People thought the number of fingers and toes was enough to count numbers.
D. People found that they could use the days in a year of a calendar to count numbers.

3. Which of the following symbols means sixteen?

- A.  B.  C.  D. 

4. What can we learn from the article?

- A. The Mayan number system had a base 10.
B. All number systems had the same symbols.
C. There were only 360 days in the Mayan calendar.
D. The symbol of zero first appeared in the Mayan number system.

5. Where can you probably find the article?

- A. A diary. B. An encyclopedia. C. A travel guide. D. A geography magazine.

Laughing is one of life's simplest pleasures. It's free. You can do it anywhere and it makes you feel good. Laughter is infectious (感染的). Often when we hear someone laughing in a crowded room or on a packed train, for example, we start laughing too — even if we have no idea why.

Making others laugh is an act of joy and kindness. However, when people laugh at you, it's not. That experience is lonely and no fun at all. For example, if Anna is in a funny play and people laugh with her, that's a good thing. However, if she forgets her lines, people may laugh at her. That isn't so good. People might even call her a laughingstock (笑柄). No one, not even a professional comedian (喜剧演员), wants to be a laughingstock.

For example, let's say a boy likes dancing with teddy bears. He records it and accidentally (偶然地) sends it to one of his classmates. The classmate shares the video with others and the boy becomes the laughingstock of the whole school.

But our story doesn't end there. Someone posts the video online and over 10 million people watch it. Then, the boy gets lots of offers to make advertisements for teddy bears and makes a lot of money. Now, you can say the boy has the last laugh. When you have the last laugh, you end up winning.

Another way to have the last laugh is to simply laugh off a difficult situation. It shows you just don't care. For example, if the boy is a friend of yours, you can tell him to just laugh it off.

1. Why do we possibly follow someone else to laugh on a packed train?

- | | |
|---|------------------------------------|
| A. Because laughing is free. | B. Because we have no idea why. |
| C. Because laughing makes us feel lonely. | D. Because laughter is infectious. |

2. From the second paragraph, we can learn that _____.

- | | |
|----------------------------------|---|
| A. being a laughingstock is fun | B. we shouldn't laugh |
| C. laughing at someone is no fun | D. making others laugh is too difficult |

3. A professional comedian _____.

- | | |
|--------------------------------|--|
| A. wants to be a laughingstock | B. wouldn't like to be a laughingstock |
| C. likes to laugh at others | D. often forgets the lines |

4. If one has the last laugh, he _____ in the end.

- | | |
|-----------------------|-----------------------------------|
| A. achieves success | B. is still a laughingstock |
| C. makes others laugh | D. doesn't care about the results |

5. If someone makes fun of your sister and you want to tell her not to pay too much attention to it, you can say, "_____".

- | | |
|----------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| A. You're really a laughingstock | B. Hey, just laugh it off. |
| C. It's not funny—don't laugh. | D. You have the last laugh. |

We sometimes say the lion is “the king of the forest” because it is stronger and more dangerous than the other animals. It can run faster than most other animals and it can hunt other beasts. It is said that the lion is the highest animal in the land food chain (链). In the sea, people say the shark is at the top of the food chain. It can swim faster than most of the other sea animals. It can also use its sharp teeth to catch other sea animals and eat them.

What is at the top of the world’s food chain? Human beings! We are not the biggest or fastest, but we are the cleverest. We could not run faster than most animals, so we invented cars. We could not fight better than a lion, we invented guns.

People’s inventions are clever, but they can be dangerous, too. For example, people used guns to kill a lot of wild wolves. People thought they posed a threat to their sheep. But in recent years, the number of wild rabbits is becoming larger and larger because the number of wild wolves is getting smaller and smaller. The wild rabbits competed for the grass with the sheep and the cows, much of the grassland became desert because it was seriously destroyed by the wild rabbits.

Remember that we are part of the food chain, so we are in danger, too! Protecting animals is protecting ourselves!

1. _____ is at the top of the food chain in the sea.
A. The shark B. The lion C. Human beings D. The dolphin
2. People’s inventions can be sometimes dangerous because _____.
A. they can kill a lot of wild wolves B. they can destroy the food chain
C. they can destroy the grassland D. they can make wild rabbits grow bigger and bigger
3. What does the underlined word “threat” refer to?
A. 猎物 B. 威胁 C. 同类 D. 契机
4. What’s the purpose of this passage?
A. To tell people who is at the top of the food chain.
B. To discuss why human beings invented cars and guns.
C. To show the importance of wild wolves.
D. To make us pay more attention to what we do to the animals.

Shyness is a kind of fear. People who are shy always worry too much about what people think of them or embarrassing (使尴尬) themselves in some way in front of others. How can we overcome shyness?

Have a good posture (姿势)

The way a person holds himself/ herself says a lot about that person. People with sloped (倾斜的) shoulders don't think of themselves as important. So stand up straight, put your shoulders back, keep your head up, and always make eye contact (接触). By practicing good posture, you will feel you have the ability to do things well.

Increase your walking speed

You can tell if a person is confident (自信的) by the way he/ she walks. People who walk in a slow way, and look at the ground while they walk usually have no confidence in themselves. However, people who have confidence in themselves walk faster. That is because they have important things to do, friends to meet, places to go, etc. So walk a little faster, keep your head up, and look straight ahead.

Do some exercise

Exercise increases your energy levels in the body. That will put you in a more positive (积极的) state of mind. By doing exercise, you will feel sure of yourself. Think about it; it is better to do some exercise than just watching TV all day.

Do things that make you feel good about yourself

This can be anything that you really like doing like going to the theater, listening to music, traveling, helping someone out of a problem, etc.

1. According to the passage, which of the following is a good posture?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A. Standing with the weight on one leg. | B. Communicating through eye contact. |
| C. Crossing legs for a long time. | D. Looking down at a phone with a bent neck for hours. |

2. What posture can help us get to know he is confident?

- | | |
|---|--------------------------------|
| A. Walking with arms close to the body. | B. Looking down at the ground. |
| C. Stepping a bit faster, with head up. | D. Moving with a slow pace. |

3. To overcome shyness, what ought we to do?

- A. Practice more to form a good posture.
B. Do more sports in our spare time.
C. Try anything that can make ourselves feel good.
D. All of the above.

4. According to the passage, what's a shy girl like?

- A. She likes making eye contact with others while talking.
- B. She is not afraid to try new things.
- C. She will feel nervous when she is asked to answer questions in class.
- D. She is good at expressing her opinions in public.

5. What is the purpose of this passage?

- A. To show us what shyness is.
- B. To tell us increasing your walking speed is the best way to overcome shyness.
- C. To teach us what can help us to have a good posture.
- D. To give us some tips to overcome shyness.

The smartphone and the computer are two important inventions in our daily life. They help us in many ways, but they may also lead to health problems.

First, looking at the screen of your smartphone or computer for too long can make your eyes dry. It is not good for your eyesight. To help your eyes keep healthy, you can follow the “20-20-20” rule—after 20 minutes’ use of eyes, look at something 20 feet away for 20 seconds.

Next, other parts of our body could also become worse because of using smartphones. When we write a lot of text messages (信息), we can develop “texting thumbs (拇指)”. It will stop us from holding things well. So we have to exercise our thumbs and fingers from time to time.

In addition, smartphones could hurt our brain. One of the biggest problems is that using smartphones can have bad effects on our sleep. Doctors say the screen light keeps us from feeling sleepy. So they advise people not to use smartphones for at least one hour before sleeping.

Finally, another serious danger is Internet addiction (瘾). Many people go on the Internet to keep themselves off feeling nervous, sad or lonely. Over time, they may start to be addicted to the Internet and feel worried if they’re not online. One way to work out this problem is to control the time they spend on the Internet.

All in all, make sure you follow the above advice to use your smartphone or your computer safely. Also, remember to enjoy your life more than just looking at the screens.

1. What does the first “20” in the “20-20-20” rule in Paragraph 2 mean?

- A. How long you use your eyes. B. How often you take a break.
C. How far you look at things from you. D. How many things you need to do at the break.

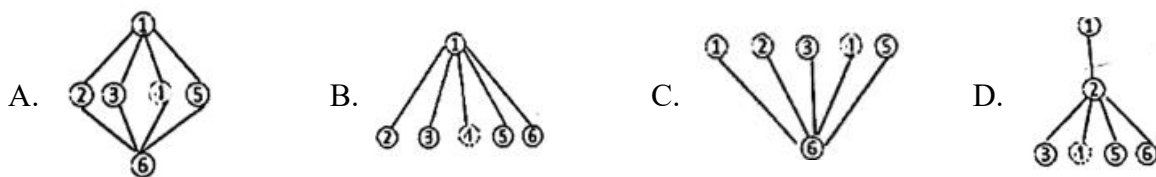
2. How many health problems are mentioned in the passage?

- A. Six. B. Three. C. Four. D. Five.

3. To keep off Internet addiction, what does the writer advise us to do?

- A. Stay away from bad feelings. B. Control the time of using the Internet.
C. Use the Internet in a safe place. D. Stop using the Internet.

4. What is the structure of the passage?



Wukong, Tiangong, Tianwen... Do you know where these names of Chinese space programs come from?

Wukong, the Dark Matter Particle Explorer satellite (暗物质粒子探测卫星), is named after the Monkey King, a Chinese superhero. According to *Journey to the West*, the Monkey King has a pair of sharp eyes which can tell the difference between good and evil. The Wukong satellite is just as sharp-eyed as the Monkey King, helping scientists search for dark matter in space.

The name of the space station, Tiangong, means “Heavenly Palace”. In Chinese myths (神话) this is the home of *Tian Di* (Heavenly Emperor). Now Tiangong Space Station is a home for Chinese astronauts in space. And China welcomes foreign astronauts to Tiangong, so they can work together in the future.

Tianwen, China’s Mars mission (火星任务), is named after the poem *Tianwen* by Qu Yuan, a well-known poet from ancient China. In *Tianwen*, he asked the questions about the sky, stars, nature, myths and the real world, showing his hunger for the truth. Perhaps the Tianwen mission will help answer some of Qu Yuan’s questions.

If you look into more Chinese space programs, you will find that their names all have beautiful meanings. We, the Chinese people, have a long-cherished (珍藏已久的) space dream, so the naming of Chinese space programs is taken very seriously.

1. How does the writer introduce the topic in Paragraph 1?

- | | |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------|
| A. By listing a number. | B. By giving an example. |
| C. By asking a question. | D. By answering a question. |

2. What does the underlined word “evil” mean?

- | | | | |
|-------------|-------------|--------------|--------------|
| A. Honesty. | B. Badness. | C. Kindness. | D. Ugliness. |
|-------------|-------------|--------------|--------------|

3. What do the satellite Wukong and the Monkey King have in common (相似)?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A. They’re both sharp-eyed. | B. They’re both superheroes. |
| C. They both help with scientific studies. | D. They both help the good and punish the bad. |

4. What is Tiangong used for?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A. It’s used for searching dark matter. | B. It’s used to explore (探索) Mars. |
| C. It’s used to send astronauts to space. | D. It’s used as a home for the astronauts in space. |

5. Why do we take the naming of Chinese space programs seriously?

- | | |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| A. We want to land on Mars. | B. We want to protect the Earth. |
| C. We have the hunger for truth. | D. We have a dream for space. |

Nature is amazing! Take a close look at the world of insects, and you'll find many unbelievable things. Think about butterflies, for example. They have beautiful colourful wings and strong fantastic flying skills. In summer, you can see them flying freely over flower gardens and wild fields.

But do you know how butterflies become flying insects? It's one of the amazing wonders of nature. In the beginning, female butterflies lay a small and colourful egg on a leaf or stem (茎) of a plant.

It's hard to believe that the egg will become something completely different in a few days. It turns into a walking insect. This insect is called a caterpillar. It now has legs, eyes and a large body. A new life has begun. The caterpillar can eat, walk and see, but it is still not a butterfly.

Soon, after growing big, the caterpillar makes a cover for itself. It covers itself in a protective blanket (保护层) and goes to sleep. This stage is known as the "pupa (蛹)" stage.

After a period of time, the blanket breaks and a wet, weak butterfly appears. It now has six legs, a mouth, eyes and wings. Shortly, the wings fill with blood, and the beautiful, colourful butterfly spreads its wings and flies away.

After a few weeks, this adult butterfly lays her eggs, and the cycle begins all over again. This is just one example of the wonders of nature. Look into the woods and mountains and see what you can find next.

1. What is NOT mentioned in Paragraph 1?

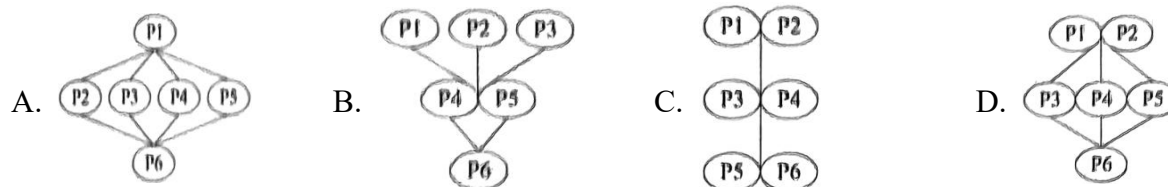
- A. Butterflies are a kind of insect. B. Butterflies are good at flying.
C. Butterflies have colourful wings. D. Butterflies have a good sense of smell.

2. What is the right order of the development of a butterfly?

- ①It becomes a pupa. ②It becomes a walking insect.
③Female butterflies lay an egg. ④It spreads wings and flies away.

- A. ①②③④ B. ①②④③ C. ③②①④ D. ③②④①

3. What's the structure of this passage? (①=Paragraph 1 ②=Paragraph 2,...)



4. What does this passage mainly talk about?

- A. Nature is quite amazing. B. The life cycle of a butterfly is amazing.
C. A butterfly has a short life. D. A butterfly is a beautiful insect.

5. Where can you probably find this text?

- A. In a fashion magazine. B. In a nature magazine.
C. In a guidebook. D. In a story book.

Libby loves science, especially chemistry. Her chemistry teacher, Mr. Darwin, once said, “It’s okay to make mistakes because they can lead to new findings. And making mistakes is more fun than cleaning up.”

One day, Mr. Darwin said, “We will run the science station at our school’s Autumn Festival. The station with the most visitors wins an ice-cream party.” He chose Libby, Rosa, and Finn to help with the station. The girls were excited. They picked three favourite experiments for the festival-making big bubbles (泡泡), mixing soft slime (史莱姆), and launching a rocket. “I can’t wait!” said Libby.

The festival day finally came. All the stations were busy except the science station, so the girls decided to try something interesting. They made big bubbles first. People started to come over. Then, Rosa used salty water to make very soft slime. “Now for the rocket! If we use more baking soda (小苏打), the rocket might go higher,” said Libby.

Unluckily, when Libby added the baking soda, an accident happened – water got on the kids. Everyone got wet and ran away. In the end, they had no visitors.

The girls didn’t win. Libby felt sad. But Mr. Darwin told them, “You three did a great job!” “But we didn’t win,” mumbled (嘟囔) Libby. “That DOESN’T mean we can’t be proud of how hard you tried. We can have our OWN ice-cream party!” “We’ll get ice and milk!” cheered the girls.

“Yum. This is delicious,” said Finn after tasting their homemade ice-cream. “It’s okay to make mistakes,” said Rosa. “And it’s so much more fun than cleaning up!” smiled Libby.

1. What is Libby’s favourite subject?

- A. Maths. B. English. C. Chemistry. D. Geography.

2. Which experiments did the girls choose to do at the science station?

- A. Making big bubbles, mixing soft slime, and launching a rocket.
B. Making big bubbles, mixing hard slime, and launching a rocket.
C. Making small bubbles, mixing soft slime, and launching a paper plane.
D. Making small bubbles, mixing hard slime, and launching a paper plane.

3. How did Libby feel when they lost?

- A. Excited. B. Angry. C. Proud. D. Unhappy.

4. What kind of person is Mr. Darwin?

- A. Boring. B. Helpful. C. Energetic. D. Careful.

5. What is the most important lesson to learn from this story?

- A. Working together is the key to success.

- B. Don't do experiments without a teacher's help.
- C. Remember to clean up after doing an experiment.
- D. Making mistakes gives us new ideas and helps us grow.

【答案】1. C 2. A 3. B 4. C 5. B

【解析】本文主要讲述了人脸识别技术的运用。

1. 细节理解题。根据第二段“A subway line in Shenzhen uses 3D facial recognition (人脸识别) technology to help recognize passengers.”和第三段“At KFC stores across China”“Customers used to carry bank cards or mobile phones to withdraw money”以及“With the help of this technology, the security check (安检) step in the airport can be completed in about 12 seconds,”可知提到了四个领域。故选 C。
2. 词义猜测题。根据“Customers used to carry bank cards or mobile phones to withdraw money”可知客户过去常常携带银行卡或手机取款，故此处划线部分意为“取钱”。故选 A。
3. 细节理解题。根据“The new technology greatly speeds up entry times”可知这项新技术大大加快了进入时间，说明了速度很快。故选 B。
4. 细节理解题。根据“and then they can enter the station just by looking into a screen at the gate for about 2 seconds”以及“With the help of this technology, the security check (安检) step in the airport can be completed in about 12 seconds, according to Guangzhou Baiyun International Airport.”可知在地铁站，大约 2 秒钟就可以进入车站，机场的安检步骤可以在大约 12 秒内完成，所以白云机场的安检时间比深圳地铁站的安检时间长。故选 C。
5. 主旨大意题。本文主要讲述了人脸识别技术的运用。故选 B。

02

How fit are your teeth? Are you lazy about brushing them? Never fear: An inventor is on the case. An electric toothbrush senses how long and how well you brush, and it lets you track your performance on your phone.

The Kolibree toothbrush was exhibited at the International Consumer Electronics Show in Las Vegas this week. It senses how it is moved and can send the information to an Android phone or iPhone via a Bluetooth wireless connection. The toothbrush will be able to teach you to brush right (Don't forget the insides of the teeth!) and make sure you're brushing long enough. "It's kind of like having a dentist actually watch your brushing on a day-to-day basis," says Thomas Serval, the French inventor.

The toothbrush will also be able to talk to other programs on your phone, so developers could, for example, create a game controlled by your toothbrush. You could score points for beating monsters among your teeth. "We try to make it smart but also fun," Serval says.

Serval says he was inspired by his experience as a father. He would come home from work and ask his kids if they had brushed their teeth. They said “yes”, but Serval would find their toothbrush heads dry. He decided he needed a brush that really told him how well his children brushed.

The company says the Kolibree will go on sale this summer, from \$99 to \$199, depending on features. The U. S. is the first target market.

Serval says that one day, it'll be possible to replace (更换) the brush on the handle with a brushing unit that also has a camera. The camera can even examine holes in your teeth while you brush.

1. Which statement about the Kolibree toothbrush is TRUE?

- A. It can send information to your phone. B. It can clean teeth all by itself.
C. It looks like a dentist. D. It can talk with us.

2. Why did Serval decide to invent the toothbrush?

- A. Because he could score points in games while brushing teeth.
B. Because he wanted to make sure his children could brush teeth well.
C. Because he wanted to replace the brush on the handle with a new one.
D. Because he wanted to invent an electric toothbrush for the market.

3. What can we know from the passage?

- A. Only parents care about children's teeth health.
B. The Kolibree toothbrush has a fixed price.
C. The toothbrush with a camera is already on the market.
D. The inventor is confident about the future of his product.

4. What is the main idea of the passage?

- A. Children do not brush teeth right.
B. A new toothbrush is able to control games.
C. People are paying more and more attention to teeth health.
D. Serval's invention will be able to check the user's teeth.

【答案】1. A 2. B 3. D 4. D

【解析】本文主要介绍了 Serval 发明的新型牙刷将能够检查使用者的牙齿。

1. 细节理解题。根据“It senses how it is moved and can send the information to an Android phone or iPhone via a Bluetooth wireless connection.”可知，Kolibree 牙刷可以将信息发送到手机。故选 A。

2. 细节理解题。根据“He decided he needed a brush that really told him how well his children brushed.”可知，Serval 发明牙刷是为了确保他的孩子能刷好牙。故选 B。

3. 推理判断题。根据“The company says the Kolibree will go on sale this summer”及“Serval says that

one day, it'll be possible to replace (更换) the brush on the handle with a brushing unit that also has a camera. The camera can even examine holes in your teeth while you brush.”可知，这款牙刷将在今年夏天上市，并且有一天可以在牙刷上装上摄像头来检查牙齿上的洞。由此可知，发明者对这款产品的未来充满了自信。故选 D。

4. 主旨大意题。本文主要介绍了 Serval 发明了一款新型牙刷，它能够检查使用者的牙齿情况。故选 D。

03



Think of a world full of pops and laughter! That is the fun of bubble wrap (气泡包装), one of the best inventions ever. But did you know that it wasn't made for popping in the beginning? This brings us to its funny story! Let's learn more about it!

In 1957, two engineers tried to invent a new kind of wallpaper. They put two shower curtains together with air bubbles between them. The result? A bumpy (不平整的), bubbly mess! Instead of cool wallpaper, they made something much more exciting.

However, bubble wrap didn't work as wallpaper at first. In fact, it wasn't used for anything because it wasn't flat! But when people saw it protected fragile things well, they sold it as packing material. Soon, people used bubble wrap to protect glass and electronics during shipping.

But it wasn't popular until people fell in love with its fun “pop”. They started popping it for enjoyment, making it a playful activity. Many say popping bubble wrap helps them relax by popping their worries away!

People use bubble wrap for packing, making art projects, and as a fun toy. Some companies make bubble wrap so that you can pop it again and again, so the fun keeps going!

The next time you open a package and hear the fun pops, think about bubble wrap's journey—from a failed wallpaper idea to a perfect stress—relieving toy. This change shows that sometimes good inventions come from happy accidents and a bit of imagination!

1. Why did the two engineers invent bubble wrap in the first place?

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|---|
| A. To create a new art project. | B. To make a stress-relieving toy. |
| C. To invent a new kind of wallpaper. | D. To protect fragile things during shipping. |

2. What does the underlined word “fragile” in paragraph 3 mean?

- | | | | |
|---------------|----------|--------------|---------------|
| A. Expensive. | B. Tiny. | C. Artistic. | D. Breakable. |
|---------------|----------|--------------|---------------|

3. Why do people like popping bubble wrap?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A. Because it looks beautiful. | B. Because it protects fragile things. |
| C. Because it helps make art projects. | D. Because it makes them feel less stressed. |

4. According to the writer, what makes this invention successful?

- A. Fun and excitement. B. Careful planning and design.
C. Lucky accidents and imagination. D. Smart people and their hard work.

5. What is the best title for the passage?

- A. Two Smart Engineers B. The Best Invention
C. The Perfect Stress-relieving Toy D. The Fun Journey of Bubble Wrap

【答案】1. C 2. D 3. D 4. C 5. D

【解析】本文讲述了两位工程师阴差阳错地发明了气泡包装的故事。

1. 细节理解题。根据“In 1957, two engineers tried to invent a new kind of wallpaper.”可知，发明人最初试图把它作为一种壁纸出售。故选 C。

2. 词义猜测题。根据划线词后文“Soon, people used bubble wrap to protect glass and electronics during shipping.”可知，后文提到了人们在运输过程中使用气泡膜来保护玻璃和电子产品，因此划线词是“易碎的”。故选 D。

3. 细节理解题。根据“They started popping it for enjoyment, making it a playful activity. Many say popping bubble wrap helps them relax by popping their worries away!”可知，人们喜欢捏气泡包装是因为它“啪啪”的爆炸声，捏起来很有趣，并且能帮他们减压。故选 D。

4. 推理判断题。通读全文，文章讲述了两位工程师阴差阳错地发明了气泡包装的故事，再根据“This change shows that sometimes good inventions come from happy accidents and a bit of imagination!”可知，文章结尾肯定了有时好的发明来自快乐的意外和一点想象力，因此这个发明的成功靠的是意外和一丝创意，故选 C。

5. 标题归纳题。本文讲述了两位工程师阴差阳错地发明了气泡包装的故事，选项 D 适合作为文章标题。故选 D。

04

Imagine that the battery on your mobile phone has run out. You can't make any calls for help and no one can contact you. You are all alone, and well, not quite. Just reach into your pocket and take out a piece of sugar. Put it into the battery, wait a minute and you are back on the phone.

Thanks to a couple of American scientists, this situation (情况) could become real. Swadesh Chaudhuri and Derek Lovely have invented the “bacteria (细菌) battery”. This kind of battery gets its power from bacteria that eat sugar and turn it into electricity.

“This is a special organism (有机体),” Lovely said. “You can get enough electricity to power a cell phone battery for about four days from a spoonful (一勺) of sugar.”

In the past, bacteria batteries have been expensive and not long-lasting. But this battery uses a more

efficient (有效率的) bacterium that can turn 80 percent of sugar into electrical energy. This is 30 percent more than similar batteries can manage.

The bacteria battery could become as small as a household battery. It is also cheap and stable (稳定的), because sugar can be taken from waste and crops.

But the sugar-to-electricity process (过程) is not satisfactory as it could take weeks for the bacteria to change a cup of sugar into electricity. And it produces “greenhouse” gases which pollute the environment.

The scientists understand there is a lot more work to be done. “It is still young,” said Lovely.

“Where we are now is where solar power was 20 or 30 years ago.”

He also believes the battery will be used in scientific equipment at the bottom of the ocean. Ocher’s ideas include using sugar in the blood to run medical devices in the human body and taking sugar from animal waste to provide energy to power homes in the countryside.

1. What’s the passage mainly about?

- A. An effective way to repair the mobile phone. B. A scientific invention of a new type of battery.
C. A clean energy to reduce the carbon dioxide. D. A new kind of mobile phone and its future.

2. Which of the following is NOT the advantage (优点) of the newly-developed battery?

- A. Convenient. B. Stable. C. Inexpensive. D. Quick.

3. Which of the following are the scientists working on to improve the new battery?

- A. Increase the bacteria. B. Solve the pollution problem.
C. Bring down the price. D. Change the size of the battery.

4. What does the underlined sentence actually mean?

- A. The bacteria battery shares some similarities with solar energy.
B. Scientists will continue their work until they find solar power.
C. There is still much room for the improvement of the bacteria battery.
D. The bacteria battery will be as popular as solar power in twenty or thirty years.

5. According to the last paragraph, who will find the bacteria battery less useful?

- A. Divers. B. Farmers. C. Doctors. D. Cooks.

【答案】1. B 2. D 3. B 4. C 5. D

【解析】本文主要讲了一种新发明“细菌电池”，这种电池的能量从吃糖的细菌中获取并将其转化为电能，并具体介绍了这种电池的优缺点。

1. 主旨大意题。通读全文，主要讲了 Swadesh Chaudhuri 和 Derek Lovely 发明了一种新型“细菌电池”，这种电池的能量从吃糖的细菌中获取并将其转化为电能，并具体介绍了这种电池的优缺点。故选 B。

2. 细节理解题。根据“The bacteria battery could become as small as a household battery. It is also cheap and stable”可知，这种电池便利，便宜且稳定；通过“But the sugar-to-electricity process is not satisfactory”，可知糖电转换过程很慢。故选 D。

3. 推理判断题。根据“it could take weeks for the bacteria to change a cup of sugar into electricity. And it produces “greenhouse” gases which pollute the environment.”可知，糖电转换过程很慢以及产生污染环境的“温室”气体，因此可推知，B 选项“解决污染问题。”应是科学家们致力于提高的方面。故选 B。

4. 推理判断题。根据“Where we are now is where solar power was 20 or 30 years ago.”可知，此处说我们现在的情况是 20 年或 30 年前太阳能的情况，太阳能技术在二三十年前也是效率不高并且弊端很多，而现在太阳能技术已经很普及了，说明这种新型电池有很大的提升空间。故选 C。

5. 推理判断题。根据最后一段可知，电池将用于海底的科学设备，其他的想法包括使用血液中的糖来运行人体内的医疗设备，以及从动物提取糖，为农村地区的家庭提供能源。通过选项可知，潜水员，农民和医生都会用上这种电池；而厨师有可能认为电池没那么有用。故选 D。

05

Scientists say they have had a “conversation” with a humpback whale (座头鲸). The scientists are from the University of California, the Alaska Whale Foundation and the SETI Institute (Search for Extraterrestrial Intelligence Institute 搜寻地球外文明研究所). They teamed up and spoke to a humpback whale named Twain. They spoke to her in “humpback language” for 20 minutes. Their conversation took place after the scientists sent a “contact call” into the ocean off the coast of Alaska. Twain heard the call and responded (回应). She swam to the research boat, circled it and chatted. The SETI Institute said it was the first ever communication between humans and a humpback whale.

The scientists said their conversation with Twain was not a deep one. Professor Brenda Mc Cowan said it was more like a series of greetings. Whales use contact calls to let other whales know where they are. The scientists made the same call 36 times over a 20-minute period. Each time, Twain responded by calling back. She even matched the intervals (间隔) between each call that the researchers made, which greatly surprised the scientists.

Professor Brenda Mc Cowan told the Business Insider website that this research could make it easier to talk to aliens (外星人). She said, “There are many kinds of intelligent beings on this planet. By studying them, we can better understand what aliens might be like.” Based on this research, scientists may identify calls from space and make first contact with aliens in the future.

1. Where did the “conversation” take place?

A. In the SETI Institute

B. In the Alaska Whale Foundation.

C. In the ocean off the coast of Alaska.

D. In the University of California.

2. Which of the following is TRUE about Twain?

- A. Twain was in poor condition.
- B. Twain jumped out of the water 36 times.
- C. Twain responded to the scientist's call 20 times.
- D. Twain was so smart that the scientists all felt surprised.

3. What can we learn from the last paragraph?

- A. Scientists have received calls from space.
- B. There are few intelligent beings on Earth.
- C. This research may help humans contact aliens.
- D. People can talk with other animals in the future.

4. Which question is answered in this passage?

- A. Why do the scientists want to search for aliens?
- B. How many scientists took part in the research?
- C. What will people do to protect humpback whales?
- D. How did the scientists have a “conversation” with Twain?

5. Where is the passage possibly from?

- A. A travel guide.
- B. A health report.
- C. A storybook.
- D. A science magazine.

【答案】1. C 2. D 3. C 4. D 5. D

【解析】本文主要介绍了科学家与座头鲸的“对话”，这是人类与座头鲸之间的首次交流。

1. 细节理解题。根据“**Their conversation took place after the scientists sent a ‘contact call’ into the ocean off the coast of Alaska.**”可知，对话发生在阿拉斯加海岸的海洋中。故选 C。

2. 推理判断题。根据“**The scientists made the same call 36 times over a 20-minute period. Each time, Twain responded by calling back. She even matched the intervals (间隔) between each call that the researchers made, which greatly surprised the scientists.**”可知，科学家们在 20 分钟内发出了 36 次同样的信号，每次 Twain 都会回应，她甚至匹配了研究人员每次通话之间的间隔，这可说明 Twain 非常聪明，科学家们对此感到惊讶。故选 D。

3. 细节理解题。根据“**Professor Brenda Mc Cowan told the Business Insider website that this research could make it easier to talk to aliens (外星人).**”可知，这项研究可能有助于人类与外星人联系。故选 C。

4. 细节理解题。根据“**They spoke to her in ‘humpback language’ for 20 minutes. Their conversation took place after the scientists sent a ‘contact call’ into the ocean off the coast of Alaska....**”可知，文中阐述了科学家通过“座头鲸语言”与 Twain 交谈了 20 分钟，因此回答了是如何与 Twain 进行“对话”的。故选 D。

5. 推理判断题。通读全文可知，本文主要介绍了科学研究和与鲸鱼的“对话”，这通常出现在科学杂志中。故选 D。



A 58-year-old grape farmer Tang Jianqin uses family skills and modern technologies to get lots of sales (买卖) since the beginning of June, and he received many online orders in October.

“I introduce (引进) at least one new kind of grapes every year to keep up with the market,” says Tang. Earlier this year, Tang introduced a new grape kind without seeds and much bigger than the ordinary grapes. It is better that the new grape kind has a brighter color and a sweeter taste. In late August, this amazing grape won the gold prize at a competition.

Tang thanks his success to today’s technologies. “WeChat groups have connected farmers and agricultural (农业) experts (专家). One can share problems and find solutions immediately.” He learns online that the control of production helps his new grape kind grow better.

For years, experts have given farmers advice online. They have also made training (培训) videos for farmers so that the farmers can watch them for many times. Tang is now good at using the Internet to run his business. Every day, he checks online orders through the local online platform.

Tang’s new grapes are now sold at 60 yuan (\$8.7) a kilogram. With the online guidance from the experts and the help from the government, he has built an agricultural center, along with a supermarket and a farming school. In the near future, the farmer hopes to keep developing his business online. “I also want to hire young people to keep up with the times,” he adds.

1. When did the farmer get online orders?

- A. In June. B. In August. C. In October. D. In November.

2. Why did the farmer introduce a new grape kind every year?

- A. To eat bigger grapes without seeds. B. To keep up with the market.
C. To show people that he is right. D. To change the fruit market.

3. What helps Tang’s new grape kind grow better?

- A. More seeds and bigger grapes. B. The control of production.
C. The gold prize in late August. D. Today’s new technologies.

4. Which are the advantages of the Internet for farmers according to Paragraph 3 and 4?

- ①Sharing problems and finding solutions ②Getting online advice from experts
③Watching training videos from the experts ④Checking orders through the international platform
A. ①②③ B. ①②④ C. ①③④ D. ②③④

5. What is the main idea of the passage?

- A. Experts learn a lot from the online training B. Family skills make the grapes grow better

C. More young people are joining in farming D. Modern technologies help farmers' business

【答案】1. C 2. B 3. B 4. A 5. D

【解析】本文是一篇说明文，主要讲述了葡萄种植者唐建平利用家庭技能和现代技术在种植方面取得的成就。

1. 细节理解题。根据第一段“A 58-year-old grape farmer Tang Jianqin uses family skills and modern technologies to get lots of sales since the beginning of June, and he received many online orders in October.”可知，葡萄种植者唐建平 10 月份收到了许多在线订单。故选 C。

2. 细节理解题。根据第二段第一句“I introduce at least one new kind of grapes every year to keep up with the market”可知，唐建平每年至少引进一种新葡萄的原因是为了跟上市场的步伐。故选 B。

3. 细节理解题。根据第三段最后一句“He learns online that the control of production helps his new grape kind grow better.”可知，对生产的控制有助于唐建平的新葡萄品种生长得更好。故选 B。

4. 推理判断题。根据第三段第三句“One can share problems and find solutions immediately 人们可以分享问题并立即找到解决方案”、第四段第一句“experts have given farmers advice online 专家们在网上给农民提供建议”及第四段第二句“They have also made training videos for farmers so that the farmers can watch them for many times 农民们可以观看相关的培训视频”可知，①②③是互联网对农民们的益处。故选 A。

5. 主旨大意题。通读全文，本文主要讲述了葡萄种植者唐建平利用家庭技能和现代技术在种植方面取得的成就，即现代技术帮助农民的生意。故选 D。

07

A new and exciting way of doing weather forecasts is here! China's television station now uses high-tech simulations (虚拟) to create realistic scenes in the studio. In a recent video about Super Typhoon Yagi, people watched as strong winds blew the weather reporter's umbrella away and a “tree” was uprooted. This new way of forecasting weather helps people understand how serious storms can be.

China Media Group Mobile made this video to warn people about the dangers of Super Typhoon Yagi and to tell them how to stay safe. But people were surprised by how real the video looked.

The weather reporter started by talking about the weather. Then, she moved to a street with heavy winds and rain, created by extended (拓展) reality (XR) technology. XR is a group of technologies that includes augmented (增强) reality (AR), virtual (虚拟) reality (VR), and mixed reality (MR).

The video showed different things that could happen during a typhoon, like trees falling and umbrellas blown away. It made people feel like they were really there, experiencing the typhoon.

With XR technology, the scenes looked real and helped people learn about the dangers of extreme (极端的) weather. Many people who watched the video said they loved the new way of doing weather

forecasts because it helped them understand better.

Super Typhoon Yagi was the strongest autumn typhoon to hit the Chinese mainland since 1949. It caused a lot of damage and problems for people. The new way of doing weather forecasts helps people see how serious extreme weather can be.

1. What happened to the weather reporter's umbrella in the weather forecast video?
A. It turned inside out. B. It broke in the wind.
C. It flew out of her hand. D. It didn't open.
2. What new technology is being used for weather forecasts in China?
A. Virtual Reality (VR) B. Augmented Reality (AR).
C. Mixed Reality (MR). D. Extended Reality (XR).
3. What does the underlined word "they" in Paragraph 4 mean?
A. The weather reporters. B. The people who watched the video.
C. The people in the video. D. The China Media Group Mobile.
4. What was the purpose of the Super Typhoon Yagi weather forecast video?
A. To warn people about the dangers of the typhoon.
B. To show off the power of XR technology.
C. To make people happy with new technology.
D. To show us the strongest autumn typhoon.
5. What's the best title for the text?
A. The development of XR technology B. The new way of doing weather forecasts
C. The ability of the weather reporter D. The dangers of Super Typhoon Yagi

【答案】1. C 2. D 3. B 4. A 5. B

【解析】本文主要介绍了中国电视台采用高科技模拟技术来预报天气，使人们能够更清楚地了解极端天气的危害。

1. 细节理解题。根据第一段“In a recent video about Super Typhoon Yagi, people watched as strong winds blew the weather reporter's umbrella away and a ‘tree’ was uprooted.”可知，天气报道记者的雨伞被强风刮走了，也就是从她手中飞了出去。故选 C。

2. 细节理解题。根据倒数第二段“With XR technology, the scenes looked real and helped people learn about the dangers of extreme weather. Many people who watched the video said they loved the new way of doing weather forecasts because it helped them understand better.”可知，利用 XR 技术，这些场景看起来很真实，并帮助人们了解极端天气的危险。许多观看视频的人表示，他们喜欢这种预报天气的新方式，因为这有助于他们更好地理解天气。故选 D。

3. 词句猜测题。根据第四段“The video showed different things that could happen during a typhoon, like trees falling and umbrellas blown away. It made people feel like they were really there, experiencing the typhoon.”可知，这段视频展示了台风期间可能发生的不同情况，比如树木倒下，雨伞被吹走。它让人们感觉他们真的在那里，经历台风。所以，此处“they”指的是观看视频的人们。故选 B。

4. 推理判断题。根据第一段“This new way of forecasting weather helps people understand how serious storms can be.”可知，这种预报天气的新方法有助于人们了解风暴的严重程度，警告人们台风的危险。故选 A。

5. 最佳标题题。通读全文可知，本文主要介绍了中国电视台采用高科技模拟技术来预报天气，使人们能够更清楚地了解极端天气的危害。故选 B。

08



Jokes made by AI lack (缺乏) creative thinking. It seems you can ask artificial intelligence (AI) programs anything, and they'll give you an answer. So, can they tell jokes?

This question was raised by a UK comedian (喜剧演员) Karen Hobbs in one of her shows in June. Instead of the usual jokes she created, Hobbs told jokes written by ChatGPT.

When Hobbs asked ChatGPT for a joke, it gave one about a man joking about getting bored with his shopping-obsessed (痴迷于购物的) girlfriend. Even when she asked to tell it from a woman's perspective (视角), it was still a shopping-obsessed girlfriend but told in the first person.

It's no surprise that many jokes by AI come from a man's perspective, as men are much more common in comedy. The BBC said that AI storytelling can only create stories based on what is already there.

A good joke in real life can always change based on the audience's reaction (反应). This is a skill that often leads comedians to improvise (即兴创作). That's something that AI can't do for now. For example, in improvise (即兴创作), comedians don't make preparations. They depend only on their natural reaction to the audience.

However, that could change. Research is being done to give AI a greater understanding of the world around it, which makes the future of AI jokes still uncertain.

1. What did Karen Hobbs do in one of her shows in June?

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| A. She told jokes written by herself. | B. She performed a magic trick. |
| C. She sang a song. | D. She told jokes written by ChatGPT. |

2. Who is more common in comedy according to the passage?

- | | | | |
|----------|---------|--------------|--------------------|
| A. Women | B. Men. | C. Children. | D. Elderly people. |
|----------|---------|--------------|--------------------|

3. What did the BBC say about AI storytelling?

- A. AI can create completely new stories.
B. AI can only create stories based on existing (现存的) ones.
C. AI storytelling is not popular.
D. AI can improvise stories like humans.
4. What do comedians depend on in improvise?
A. Their prepared scripts (手稿). B. The audience's suggestions.
C. Their natural reaction to the audience. D. Their previous performances.
5. What can be inferred (推断) from the last sentence of the passage?
A. AI jokes will never be funny.
B. The future of AI jokes is for sure.
C. AI might improve its ability to tell jokes in the future.
D. Research on AI has stopped.

【答案】1. D 2. B 3. B 4. C 5. C

【解析】本文是一篇说明文，主要讲述了人工智能在讲笑话方面所存在的不足之处。

1. 细节理解题。根据“Instead of the usual jokes she created, Hobbs told jokes written by ChatGPT.”可知，Hobbs 在她的一个节目中讲了由 ChatGPT 写的笑话。故选 D。
2. 细节理解题。根据“It's no surprise that many jokes by AI come from a man's perspective, as men are much more common in comedy.”可知，男性在喜剧中更常见。故选 B。
3. 细节理解题。根据“The BBC said that AI storytelling can only create stories based on what is already there.”可知，人工智能只能在现有故事的基础上创造故事。故选 B。
4. 细节理解题。根据“For example, in improvise (即兴创作), comedians don't make preparations. They depend only on their natural reaction to the audience.”可知，喜剧演员在即兴表演靠的是他们对观众的自然反应。故选 C。
5. 推理判断题。根据最后一句“Research is being done to give AI a greater understanding of the world around it, which makes the future of AI jokes still uncertain.”可知，人们正在进行研究，让人工智能更好地了解周围的世界，所以可以推测出，未来人工智能可能会提高讲笑话的能力。故选 C。

09

Do you have a lucky number? What is it? Many people have a special number that they hope will bring them good luck.

In Chinese culture, some numbers are believed to be lucky or unlucky based on the Chinese word that the number sounds similar to.

For example, the word for the number 8 sounds similar to the word for “making a fortune (发财)”. So,

So, what's an unlucky number in China? One example is 4. Many Chinese people see 4 as an unlucky number because it sounds similar to the character for “death”.

Because of this, many buildings skip (跳过) the fourth floor, and simply call it the fifth floor. In Hong Kong, some buildings even skip all floors numbered with 4, such as 4, 14, 24, 34 and all 40-49 floors. Some buildings also skip the 13th floor, as this is considered an unlucky number in some areas in Hong Kong. As a result, a building whose highest floor is 50 may have only 35 physical floors.

A. The shape of the number.

B. The sound of the number.

C. The history of the number.

D. The spelling of the number.

A. 35 B. 60 C. 45 D. 44

A. fortunate B. ordinary C. everlasting D. simple

- A. Numbers and old stories in China.
- B. Lucky and unlucky numbers in Chinese culture.
- C. Ways to find your lucky and unlucky numbers.
- D. Different meanings of numbers in different countries.

【解析】本文主要介绍了中国文化中的幸运数字和不幸数字。

2. 推理判断题。根据“In Hong Kong, some buildings even skip all floors numbered with 4”可知，香港

的一些建筑会跳过所有带有 4 的楼层，因此，最高 60 层的建筑要排除 4、14、24、34、44、54、40~49，因此实际只有 44 层。故选 D。

3. 细节理解题。根据“The number 9 also stands for ‘long lasting’.”可知，数字 9 在中国文化中代表“长久”，即“everlasting”。故选 C。

4. 主旨大意题。根据文章内容可知，本文主要介绍了中国文化中的幸运数字和不幸运数字。故选 B。

10

Each number is special and has its own beauty. They are basic elements (元素) of mathematics for counting, measuring, and solving equations (方程). Numbers hold a lot of fun facts and stories. Today, we invite you on a journey through some of them.

Zero

The ancient Babylonians (巴比伦人) invented zero, and it is the greatest number in the world. It was the age of Henry VI (亨利六世) when he became King of England (he was nine months old). Also when he became King of France (he was eleven months old). It's the total number of snakes in Ireland (because of the cooler and wetter environment).

Three

Three is a creepy number in some cultures. In Vietnam, it's bad luck to have three people in a photo as the one in the middle might die. It's the number of people who have been to the bottom of the ocean (the Mariana Trench). It's (on average) the number of days you can survive without water, the number of weeks you can survive without eating and the number of minutes you can survive without taking a breath.

Seven

Ah, Number Seven. It's seen as lucky or mystical (神秘的) in some cultures. It appears all the time. Seven days of the week. Seven ancient wonders. Seven Dwarves too. It's the estimated (估计) number of Northern white rhinos left in the world.

Ten

Human children need around 10 hours of sleep a night (you'd need two hours if you were a giraffe and twenty-two hours if you were a koala). 10 percent of the world is left-handed. The world's largest omelette (煎蛋) was 10 metres wide. 10 percent of people in the world live on islands.

1. What can people use numbers to do EXCEPT?

A. To count. B. To measure. C. To solve equations. D. To go traveling

2. How old was Henry VI when he became King of England?

A. One year old. B. Eleven months old. C. Nine months old. D. Six months old.

3. What can we know about Three and Seven?

- A. Three is unlucky in some cultures. B. Seven is bad luck in Vietnam.
C. Seven sometimes appear in our lives. D. People can survive 3 weeks without water.

4. How much sleep does a child need every night?

- A. 22 hours B. 10 hours C. 8 hours D. 2 hours

5. Where can we probably read this article?

- A. In a health magazine B. In a sports newspaper C. In a Maths blog D. In a travel guide

【答案】1. D 2. C 3. A 4. B 5. C

【解析】本文主要介绍了几个数字的历史和有趣事实。

1. 细节理解题。根据“**They are basic elements (元素) of mathematics for counting, measuring, and solving equations (方程).**”可知人们可以用数字数数、测量、计算和解方程，不包括去旅行。故选 D。

2. 细节理解题。根据“**It was the age of Henry VI (亨利六世) when he became King of England (he was nine months old).**”可知亨利六世在九个月大的时候成为了英国的国王。故选 C。

3. 细节理解题。根据“**Three is a creepy number in some cultures. In Vietnam, it's bad luck to have three people in a photo as the one in the middle might die.**”可知数字 3 在一些国家代表不幸。故选 A。

4. 细节理解题。根据“**Human children need around 10 hours of sleep a night (you'd need two hours if you were a giraffe and twenty-two hours if you were a koala).**”可知一个小孩每晚需要睡十个小时。故选 B。

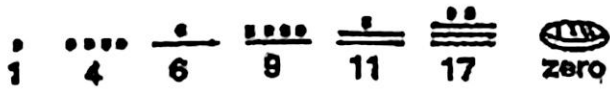
5. 推理判断题。本文主要介绍了数字的有趣事实，因此可能在数学博客上读到此文章。故选 C。

11

The Mayan number system appeared in the fourth century, which was about 1,000 years earlier than the time when the European number system was created. It is different from the Arabic number system with a base 10. The Mayan system had a base 20. This system is believed to have been used because the Mayans lived in such a warm area and there was hardly a need to wear shoes. 20 was the total number of fingers and toes, so the system was workable. Therefore, there were two important numbers in this system. Besides 20, the other important number is 5, which had a connection with the number of fingers and toes on one hand or foot.

The Mayan system used two symbols (符号). A dot (.) was used to mean the units (one to four) and a dash (—) meant five. The Mayans were also the first to create symbols of nothing (or zero). The most common symbol was that of a shell () but there were several other symbols (e.g. a head) . It is interesting to learn that with all of the great experts on Maths and scientists in ancient Greece and Rome, it was the Mayan Indians who came up with this symbol zero or nothing. The following picture is a form

of different numbers and how they would have been written.



From further study, people found that the 360 day calendar (日历) also came from the Mayan. They actually used base 18 when they made the calendar. Each month included 20 days with 18 months in a year. This left five days at the end of the year which was month in itself, full of danger and bad luck. In this way, the Mayans had invented the 365 day calendar.

1. What does the underlined “It” in paragraph 1 refer to?

- A. The European number system.
- B. The Mayan number system.
- C. The Arabic number system.
- D. The Mayan symbol system.

2. Why could the Mayan system be used at that time?

- A. People lived in such a warm area that they didn’t need to count numbers.
- B. People believed that they hardly used their fingers or toes to count numbers.
- C. People thought the number of fingers and toes was enough to count numbers.
- D. People found that they could use the days in a year of a calendar to count numbers.

3. Which of the following symbols means sixteen?



4. What can we learn from the article?

- A. The Mayan number system had a base 10.
- B. All number systems had the same symbols.
- C. There were only 360 days in the Mayan calendar.
- D. The symbol of zero first appeared in the Mayan number system.

5. Where can you probably find the article?

- A. A diary.
- B. An encyclopedia.
- C. A travel guide.
- D. A geography magazine.

【答案】1. B 2. C 3. A 4. D 5. B

【解析】本文主要阐述的是数字的起源和数字的不同体系。

1. 词义猜测题。根据“The Mayan number system appeared in the fourth century...It is different from the Arabic number system with a base 10. The Mayan system had a base 20.”可知，代词“It”指代的是“The Mayan number system”，故选 B。

2. 细节理解题。根据“This system is believed to have been used because the Mayans lived in such a

warm area and there was hardly a need to wear shoes. 20 was the total number of fingers and toes, so the system was workable.”可知，玛雅数字系统之所以能够使用，是因为人们认为手指和脚趾的总数足够计数，故选 C。

3. 细节理解题。根据“A dot (.) was used to mean the units (one to four) and a dash (—) meant five.”可知，数字 16 由 3 个“5”和 1 个“1”组成，所以需要 3 个“—”和 1 个“.”，故选 A。

4. 细节理解题。根据“The Mayans were also the first to create symbols of nothing (or zero).”可知，零的符号最早出现在玛雅数字系统。故选 D。

5. 推理判断题。本文主要阐述的是数字的起源和数字的不同体系，所以在百科全书中出现比较恰当，故选 B。

12

Laughing is one of life's simplest pleasures. It's free. You can do it anywhere and it makes you feel good. Laughter is infectious (感染的). Often when we hear someone laughing in a crowded room or on a packed train, for example, we start laughing too — even if we have no idea why.

Making others laugh is an act of joy and kindness. However, when people laugh at you, it's not. That experience is lonely and no fun at all. For example, if Anna is in a funny play and people laugh with her, that's a good thing. However, if she forgets her lines, people may laugh at her. That isn't so good. People might even call her a laughingstock (笑柄). No one, not even a professional comedian (喜剧演员), wants to be a laughingstock.

For example, let's say a boy likes dancing with teddy bears. He records it and accidentally (偶然地) sends it to one of his classmates. The classmate shares the video with others and the boy becomes the laughingstock of the whole school.

But our story doesn't end there. Someone posts the video online and over 10 million people watch it. Then, the boy gets lots of offers to make advertisements for teddy bears and makes a lot of money. Now, you can say the boy has the last laugh. When you have the last laugh, you end up winning.

Another way to have the last laugh is to simply laugh off a difficult situation. It shows you just don't care. For example, if the boy is a friend of yours, you can tell him to just laugh it off.

1. Why do we possibly follow someone else to laugh on a packed train?

- | | |
|---|------------------------------------|
| A. Because laughing is free. | B. Because we have no idea why. |
| C. Because laughing makes us feel lonely. | D. Because laughter is infectious. |

2. From the second paragraph, we can learn that _____.

- | | |
|----------------------------------|---|
| A. being a laughingstock is fun | B. we shouldn't laugh |
| C. laughing at someone is no fun | D. making others laugh is too difficult |

3. A professional comedian _____.

A. wants to be a laughingstock

B. wouldn't like to be a laughingstock

C. likes to laugh at others

D. often forgets the lines

4. If one has the last laugh, he _____ in the end.

A. achieves success

B. is still a laughingstock

C. makes others laugh

D. doesn't care about the results

5. If someone makes fun of your sister and you want to tell her not to pay too much attention to it, you can say, "_____".

A. You're really a laughingstock

B. Hey, just laugh it off.

C. It's not funny—don't laugh.

D. You have the last laugh.

【答案】1. D 2. C 3. B 4. A 5. B

【解析】本文主要介绍了应怎样面对别人的嘲笑。

1. 细节理解题。根据“Laughter is infectious (感染的). Often when we hear someone laughing in a crowded room or on a packed train,”可知，笑声是有感染力的，例如，当我们听到有人在拥挤的房间或拥挤的火车上大笑时，我们也开始跟着大笑。故选 D。

2. 细节理解题，根据“However, when people laugh at you, it's not. That experience is lonely and no fun at all.”可知，当人们嘲笑你的时候，这种经历是孤独的，一点也不有趣。故选 C。

3. 细节理解题。根据“People might even call her a laughingstock (笑柄). No one, not even a professional comedian (喜剧演员), wants to be a laughingstock.”可知，没有人愿意成为笑柄，即使是职业喜剧演员也不例外。故选 B。

4. 推理判断题。根据“Then, the boy gets lots of offers to make advertisements for teddy bears and makes a lot of money. Now, you can say the boy has the last laugh. When you have the last laugh, you end up winning.”可知，男孩笑到了最后，去打广告赚了钱，因此当一个人笑到最后，他最终会获得成功。故选 A。

5. 细节理解题。根据“Another way to have the last laugh is to simply laugh off a difficult situation. It shows you just don't care. For example, if the boy is a friend of yours, you can tell him to just laugh it off.”可知，笑到最后的另一种方法是在面对困难的情况时，简单地笑出来，这表明你不在乎。因此如果有人取笑你的妹妹，而你想让她不要太在意，你可以叫她一笑置之。故选 B。

13

We sometimes say the lion is “the king of the forest” because it is stronger and more dangerous than the other animals. It can run faster than most other animals and it can hunt other beasts. It is said that the lion is the highest animal in the land food chain (链). In the sea, people say the shark is at the top of the

food chain. It can swim faster than most of the other sea animals. It can also use its sharp teeth to catch other sea animals and eat them.

What is at the top of the world's food chain? Human beings! We are not the biggest or fastest, but we are the cleverest. We could not run faster than most animals, so we invented cars. We could not fight better than a lion, we invented guns.

People's inventions are clever, but they can be dangerous, too. For example, people used guns to kill a lot of wild wolves. People thought they posed a threat to their sheep. But in recent years, the number of wild rabbits is becoming larger and larger because the number of wild wolves is getting smaller and smaller. The wild rabbits competed for the grass with the sheep and the cows, much of the grassland became desert because it was seriously destroyed by the wild rabbits.

Remember that we are part of the food chain, so we are in danger, too! Protecting animals is protecting ourselves!

1. _____ is at the top of the food chain in the sea.

A. The shark B. The lion C. Human beings D. The dolphin

2. People's inventions can be sometimes dangerous because _____.

A. they can kill a lot of wild wolves B. they can destroy the food chain
C. they can destroy the grassland D. they can make wild rabbits grow bigger and bigger

3. What does the underlined word "threat" refer to?

A. 猎物 B. 威胁 C. 同类 D. 契机

4. What's the purpose of this passage?

A. To tell people who is at the top of the food chain.
B. To discuss why human beings invented cars and guns.
C. To show the importance of wild wolves.
D. To make us pay more attention to what we do to the animals.

【答案】1. A 2. B 3. B 4. D

【解析】本文介绍了狮子是陆地食物链的顶端，鲨鱼是海洋食物链的顶端，而整个世界食物链的顶端是人类。人类是食物链的一部分，我们要注意保护动物，才能维持生态平衡。

1. 细节理解题。根据“In the sea, people say the shark is at the top of the food chain.”可知，海洋中鲨鱼是食物链的顶端。故选 A。

2. 细节理解题。根据短文第二段举的例子可知，人们用枪杀死了许多野狼。近年来，因为野狼的数量越来越少，野兔的数量增多，由于野兔的严重破坏，许多草原变成了沙漠。由此可知人们破坏了生物链。故选 B。

3. 词义猜测题。根据语境“*For example, many years ago in Inner Mongolia, people used guns to kill a lot of wild wolves. People thought they posed a threat to their sheep.*”可知，人们用枪杀死野狼，因为人们觉得狼对羊来说是一个威胁。threat“威胁”。故选 B。

4. 主旨大意题。根据文意和短文最后一段“*Remember that we are part of the food chain, so we are in danger, too! If we love animals, we are loving ourselves.*”我们是食物链的一部分！爱护动物，就是爱护我们自己。由此可知，这篇短文是为了让我们更多的关注动物。故选 D。

14

Shyness is a kind of fear. People who are shy always worry too much about what people think of them or embarrassing (使尴尬) themselves in some way in front of others. How can we overcome shyness?

Have a good posture (姿势)

The way a person holds himself/ herself says a lot about that person. People with sloped (倾斜的) shoulders don't think of themselves as important. So stand up straight, put your shoulders back, keep your head up, and always make eye contact (接触). By practicing good posture, you will feel you have the ability to do things well.

Increase your walking speed

You can tell if a person is confident (自信的) by the way he/ she walks. People who walk in a slow way, and look at the ground while they walk usually have no confidence in themselves. However, people who have confidence in themselves walk faster. That is because they have important things to do, friends to meet, places to go, etc. So walk a little faster, keep your head up, and look straight ahead.

Do some exercise

Exercise increases your energy levels in the body. That will put you in a more positive (积极的) state of mind. By doing exercise, you will feel sure of yourself. Think about it; it is better to do some exercise than just watching TV all day.

Do things that make you feel good about yourself

This can be anything that you really like doing like going to the theater, listening to music, traveling, helping someone out of a problem, etc.

1. According to the passage, which of the following is a good posture?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A. Standing with the weight on one leg. | B. Communicating through eye contact. |
| C. Crossing legs for a long time. | D. Looking down at a phone with a bent neck for hours. |

2. What posture can help us get to know he is confident?

- | | |
|---|--------------------------------|
| A. Walking with arms close to the body. | B. Looking down at the ground. |
|---|--------------------------------|

C. Stepping a bit faster, with head up. D. Moving with a slow pace.

3. To overcome shyness, what ought we to do?

A. Practice more to form a good posture.

B. Do more sports in our spare time.

C. Try anything that can make ourselves feel good.

D. All of the above.

4. According to the passage, what's a shy girl like?

A. She likes making eye contact with others while talking.

B. She is not afraid to try new things.

C. She will feel nervous when she is asked to answer questions in class.

D. She is good at expressing her opinions in public.

5. What is the purpose of this passage?

A. To show us what shyness is.

B. To tell us increasing your walking speed is the best way to overcome shyness.

C. To teach us what can help us to have a good posture.

D. To give us some tips to overcome shyness.

【答案】1. B 2. C 3. D 4. C 5. D

【解析】本文是一篇说明文，作者给出了四条克服害羞的建议。

1. 细节理解题。根据原文“**So stand up straight, put your shoulders back, keep your head up, and always make eye contact (接触)**”可知，沟通时有眼神接触是一种好的姿态。故选 B。

2. 细节理解题。根据原文“**So walk a little faster, keep your head up, and look straight ahead**”可知，走快一点，抬头，直视前方，由这些动作可以知道此人是一个自信的人。故选 C。

3. 细节理解题。根据原文“**1. Have a good posture (姿势) | 2. Increase your walking speed | 3. Do some exercise | 4. Do things that make you feel good about yourself**”可知，作者给出了四条克服害羞的建议，即①保持良好的姿势；②增加步行速度；③做一些运动；④做一些让你自我感觉良好的事情。故选 D。

4. 推理判断题。根据原文“**Shyness is a kind of fear. People who are shy always worry too much about what people think of them or embarrassing (使尴尬) themselves in some way in front of others**”可知，害羞是一种恐惧。害羞的人总是太担心别人对他们的看法，或者在别人面前让自己尴尬。C 选项“当她在课堂上被要求回答问题时，她会感到紧张”符合语境，故选 C。

5. 细节理解题。根据原文“**How can we overcome shyness?**”可知，本文是一篇说明文，作者给出了四条克服害羞的建议。故选 D。

1. 细节理解题。根据第二段“you can follow the ‘20-20-20’ rule—after 20 minutes’ use of eyes, look at something 20 feet away for 20 seconds”可知，第一个“20”指的是“用眼时长”。故选 A。
2. 细节理解题。根据第二段“First, looking at the screen of your smartphone or computer for too long can make your eyes dry.”，第三段“Next, other parts of our body could also become worse because of using smartphones.”，第四段“In addition, smartphones could hurt our brain.”以及第五段“Finally, another serious danger is Internet addiction (瘾).”可知，文中提到了 4 种健康问题。故选 C。
3. 细节理解题。根据第五段“One way to work out this problem is to control the time they spend on the Internet.”可知，为了防止网瘾，作者建议我们控制上网的时间。故选 B。
4. 篇章结构题。第一段用于引出话题；第二至五段分别讲述了过度使用智能手机和电脑可能会引起的健康问题以及相应的建议；第六段总结全文。故选 A。

16

Wukong, Tiangong, Tianwen... Do you know where these names of Chinese space programs come from?

Wukong, the Dark Matter Particle Explorer satellite (暗物质粒子探测卫星), is named after the Monkey King, a Chinese superhero. According to *Journey to the West*, the Monkey King has a pair of sharp eyes which can tell the difference between good and evil. The Wukong satellite is just as sharp-eyed as the Monkey King, helping scientists search for dark matter in space.

The name of the space station, Tiangong, means “Heavenly Palace”. In Chinese myths (神话) this is the home of *Tian Di* (Heavenly Emperor). Now Tiangong Space Station is a home for Chinese astronauts in space. And China welcomes foreign astronauts to Tiangong, so they can work together in the future.

Tianwen, China’s Mars mission (火星任务), is named after the poem *Tianwen* by Qu Yuan, a well-known poet from ancient China. In *Tianwen*, he asked the questions about the sky, stars, nature, myths and the real world, showing his hunger for the truth. Perhaps the Tianwen mission will help answer some of Qu Yuan’s questions.

If you look into more Chinese space programs, you will find that their names all have beautiful meanings. We, the Chinese people, have a long-cherished (珍藏已久的) space dream, so the naming of Chinese space programs is taken very seriously.

1. How does the writer introduce the topic in Paragraph 1?

- | | |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------|
| A. By listing a number. | B. By giving an example. |
| C. By asking a question. | D. By answering a question. |

2. What does the underlined word “evil” mean?

- | | | | |
|-------------|-------------|--------------|--------------|
| A. Honesty. | B. Badness. | C. Kindness. | D. Ugliness. |
|-------------|-------------|--------------|--------------|

3. What do the satellite Wukong and the Monkey King have in common (相似)?
- A. They're both sharp-eyed. B. They're both superheroes.
C. They both help with scientific studies. D. They both help the good and punish the bad.
4. What is Tiangong used for?
- A. It's used for searching dark matter. B. It's used to explore (探索) Mars.
C. It's used to send astronauts to space. D. It's used as a home for the astronauts in space.
5. Why do we take the naming of Chinese space programs seriously?
- A. We want to land on Mars. B. We want to protect the Earth.
C. We have the hunger for truth. D. We have a dream for space.

【答案】1. C 2. B 3. A 4. D 5. D

【解析】本文是一篇说明文。文章主要介绍了太空项目命名的由来。

1. 细节理解题。根据第一段“Wukong, Tiangong, Tianwen... Do you know where these names of Chinese space programs come from?”可知，文章是以问问题来开篇的。故选 C。
2. 词句猜测题。根据“According to Journey to the West, the Monkey King has a pair of sharp eyes which can tell the difference between good and evil.”及常识可知，根据《西游记》，孙悟空有一双锐利的眼睛，可以分辨善恶，所以划线部分的含义是“邪恶”，所以 B 项符合。故选 B。
3. 细节理解题。根据第二段中的“The Wukong satellite is just as sharp-eyed as the Monkey King, helping scientists search for dark matter in space.”可知，卫星悟空和孙悟空的共同之处在于两者都有着锐利的眼睛。故选 A。
4. 细节理解题。根据第三段中的“Now Tiangong Space Station is a home for Chinese astronauts in space.”可知，天宫空间站是中国宇航员的太空家园。故选 D。
5. 细节理解题。根据最后一段中的“We, the Chinese people, have a long-cherished (珍藏已久的) space dream, so the naming of Chinese space programs is taken very seriously.”可知，我们认真对待中国太空计划的命名，因为我们有一个太空梦想。故选 D。

17

Nature is amazing! Take a close look at the world of insects, and you'll find many unbelievable things. Think about butterflies, for example. They have beautiful colourful wings and strong fantastic flying skills. In summer, you can see them flying freely over flower gardens and wild fields.

But do you know how butterflies become flying insects? It's one of the amazing wonders of nature. In the beginning, female butterflies lay a small and colourful egg on a leaf or stem (茎) of a plant.

It's hard to believe that the egg will become something completely different in a few days. It turns into a walking insect. This insect is called a caterpillar. It now has legs, eyes and a large body. A new life

has begun. The caterpillar can eat, walk and see, but it is still not a butterfly.

Soon, after growing big, the caterpillar makes a cover for itself. It covers itself in a protective blanket (保护层) and goes to sleep. This stage is known as the “pupa (蛹)” stage.

After a period of time, the blanket breaks and a wet, weak butterfly appears. It now has six legs, a mouth, eyes and wings. Shortly, the wings fill with blood, and the beautiful, colourful butterfly spreads its wings and flies away.

After a few weeks, this adult butterfly lays her eggs, and the cycle begins all over again. This is just one example of the wonders of nature. Look into the woods and mountains and see what you can find next.

1. What is NOT mentioned in Paragraph 1?

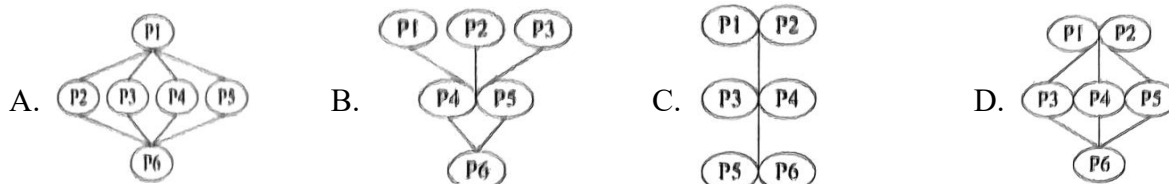
- A. Butterflies are a kind of insect. B. Butterflies are good at flying.
C. Butterflies have colourful wings. D. Butterflies have a good sense of smell.

2. What is the right order of the development of a butterfly?

- ①It becomes a pupa. ②It becomes a walking insect.
③Female butterflies lay an egg. ④It spreads wings and flies away.

- A. ①②③④ B. ①②④③ C. ③②①④ D. ③②④①

3. What's the structure of this passage? (①=Paragraph 1 ②=Paragraph 2,...)



4. What does this passage mainly talk about?

- A. Nature is quite amazing. B. The life cycle of a butterfly is amazing.
C. A butterfly has a short life. D. A butterfly is a beautiful insect.

5. Where can you probably find this text?

- A. In a fashion magazine. B. In a nature magazine.
C. In a guidebook. D. In a story book.

【答案】1. D 2. C 3. A 4. B 5. B

【解析】本文主要讲述蝴蝶生命中的几个阶段。

1. 细节理解题。根据第一段中的“Take a close look at the world of insects, and you’ll find many unbelievable things. Think about butterflies, for example.”可知，A 项提及；根据第一段中的“They have beautiful colourful wings and strong fantastic flying skills.”可知，B 项和 C 项提及。故选 D。

2. 细节理解题。根据第二段中的“In the beginning, female butterflies lay a small and colourful egg on a

leaf or stem (茎) of a plant.”可知，③排第一；根据第三段中的“*It’s hard to believe that the egg will become something completely different in a few days. It turns into a walking insect.*”可知，②排第二；根据第四段中的“*This stage is known as the ‘pupa (蛹)’ stage.*”可知，①排第三；根据倒数第二段中的“*Shortly, the wings fill with blood, and the beautiful, colourful butterfly spreads its wings and flies away.*”可知，④排最后。故选 C。

3. 篇章结构题。通读全文可知，①为总起，举例说明大自然中的昆虫世界很神奇，引出下文；②③④⑤介绍了蝴蝶从卵变成蝴蝶的过程；⑥为总结，介绍了自然世界中还有很多神奇的东西。故选 A。

4. 主旨大意题。根据最后一段中的“*After a few weeks, this adult butterfly lays her eggs, and the cycle begins all over again.*”并通读全文可知，本文主要讲述蝴蝶生命中的几个阶段。故选 B。

5. 推理判断题。通读全文可知，本文主要讲述蝴蝶生命中的几个阶段，属于自然范畴。故选 B。